

Digital Services Act

Transparency Report for Feedback Portal

February 2025

Introduction

This report will cover the Feedback Portal, located at <https://aka.ms/feedbackportal>. This is a community website where users can publicly or privately post feedback, upvote and comment on the feedback provided by others in the community, and view feedback they have provided (either privately or publicly) to Microsoft. Microsoft employees can post official status updates and communications to user feedback via the portal, which viewers can then read on the respective feedback items.

The above-mentioned products have been designated by the European Commission as “non-VLO services” and are therefore subject to the European Commission’s Digital Services Act (DSA) Article 42 requirements to publish certain information in an annual disclosure. This DSA Transparency Report is responsive to the obligations under DSA Article 15(1), Article 24(1), and Article 42(2)-(3). This Report provides information regarding the following topics as they pertain to the European Union:

- Content Moderation at Microsoft’s Initiative
- Content Moderation & Automated Systems
- Content Moderation following a User Report
- Content Moderation Appeals
- Government Requests

Content Moderation at Microsoft’s Initiative

This section describes activities Feedback Portal undertakes at its own initiative to address illegal content or information in violation of Feedback Portal’s terms and conditions, which can be found in its [Code of Conduct](#).

The content moderation that Feedback Portal performs at its own initiative falls into two categories: Automated content detection for Spam, personal information, or other material that violates the feedback portal [Code of Conduct](#). Additionally, employees at Microsoft and/or vendors with access to feedback data may manually review and moderate feedback that was not flagged by users or caught by our automated moderation techniques.

To automate detection of feedback that violates our Code of Conduct or Terms of Use, our feedback product teams have authored manually lists of terms or phrases that are deemed inappropriate. Incoming feedback (after translation) is checked against these automated rules, and feedback that matches the automated rule criteria is automatically moderated. Feedback Portal only supports text feedback, so there is no need for image or file attachment scanning techniques, as there is no way for a user to submit anything outside of text.

To help keep content moderation consistent, we have a team of vendors that the feedback team oversees. Each of these vendors participates in our training material that explains moderator responsibilities and how to moderate, and has undergone training in our triage and moderation tools. We have an internal feedback loop where we have continued to improve our tools based on feedback from our moderators, and we can track their activities with detailed history on each feedback record of any action taken on that feedback, including moderation.

Violating content is blocked from sharing or is removed, and, in the case of egregious violations such as sharing child sexual abuse material, the Microsoft account of the content owner may also be terminated in accordance with Microsoft's published policies.

Policy Violation	Number of measures taken at the provider's own initiative	Number of measures taken after detection with solely automated means	Visibility restriction Interaction restricted
Scope of Platform Services	609	609	609

Content Moderation & Automated Systems

Feedback Portal uses use of automated moderation of feedback records is based solely on matching exact keywords that have been deemed to represent feedback that violates the code of conduct. Words disallowed (swear words) and other recognizable patterns of spam (phishing, phone numbers, etc.) are moderated out.

Additionally, if a Microsoft Account posts more than 3 feedback records or 6 comments in 5 minutes, 7 feedback records or 14 comments in one day, or 20 feedback records of 40 comments in one week, we have heuristically determined a high likelihood that the user account is creating spam. In these cases, the account is banned and the feedback is moderated out.

This content is not deleted or removed, simply hidden from public view on the feedback portal. The original poster of the feedback can still view it privately in their My Feedback section.

The purpose of automated moderation is to remove content from the Feedback Portal that violates our Terms of Use or Code of Conduct before requiring users to flag and report the feedback manually. We strive to promote a safe, engaging community experience and automated moderation in addition to reviewing feedback flagged by users is part of a comprehensive strategy to achieve this goal.

Human review of feedback moderated in this manner has allowed us to correct for any errors and to revise our pattern matching over time. In the event that we discover feedback was hidden from public view that should have been permissible, we can manually set the feedback to a “no violation” state to allow it to once again be published on the Feedback Portal.

	Feedback Portal
Number of measures not taken by automated means	613

Content Moderation following a User Report

Microsoft provides the information below in response to DSA Articles 15(1)(b)-(c) and 41(2)(a)-(b).

Posted in [Excel](#)

Feedback collection

2 years ago

Get Tables working on protected sheets (add rows, sort, filter, etc.)

Last edited by The Microsoft Feedback Team 2 years ago

I would like to be able to have the ability to add/remove rows of a table which resides on a protected sheet. Currently if you protect a sheet you can't insert/delete rows of a table. Even if you unprotect all cells and allow inserting/deleting of rows on sheet protection, it doesn't matter and is completely ignored. What I am proposing would have to follow specific rules: Table cells would have to be unprotected. Cells below table would have to be unprotected (truly optional) Insert Rows would have to be specified in sheet protection The way table rows are inserted is different than a standard row insert. If there are blank rows below the table it will extend to those rows, and not shift things down. If there is data below the table, it will extend to all rows between the two, and then start inserting. This mechanism would make the second item above optional depending on how you [Microsoft] would handle this internally. My preference would be to have the cells unlocked, and honor the protection status of the cell, and not overwrite, or "consume" if there is space available.

We're looking into this

Web

Official Microsoft response

SK

Steve K.

Official Microsoft response

2 years ago

Thanks for logging this great suggestion and to others for voting it up. We'll prioritize this according to the number of votes, so if there's more interest, please make sure to register your vote! Thanks

448 votes

21 comments

Follow

Share

2 flags

Submit a report

* required field

Report Category *

Choose Reason

Description

Tell us more about why you're reporting this content (optional).

☐ Report anonymously

Report

Cancel

Submit a report

* required field

Report Category *

Choose Reason

Bullying and Harassment

Hate speech

Sexual Solicitation

Suicide and Self-injury

Child Sexual Exploitation and Abuse

Intellectual property infringement

Sensitive/personal data

Off-topic

Other

Submit a report

✕

* required field

Report Category *

Off-topic

Description

Tell us more about why you're reporting this content (optional).

☐ Report anonymously

Report

Cancel

Policy Violation	Number of notices received	Number of specific items of information included in the total number of notices	Median time to take action (in hours)	Number of actions taken on the basis of the terms and conditions of the service
Illegal or Harmful Speech	15	15		
IP Infringements	5	5		
Nonconsensual Behaviour	26	26		
Pornography or Sexualized Content	9	9	5.0	
Protection of Minors	10	10		
Risk for public security	1	1		
Scams and Fraud				
Scope of Platform Services	35	35	5.5	4
Self Harm	4	4		
Violence	3	3		

Content Moderation Appeals

In the event that Feedback portal receives notice of an appeal to a moderation action, via customer support channels, we have the ability to re-review any moderated feedback and have the ability to

make feedback publicly available again that was moderated if the feedback indeed is not illegal or violate our code of conduct policies.

Government Requests

Feedback Portal did not receive notice of any government requests to remove feedback during the reporting period.